

“We Establish Robot Labs In Universities For Hands-On Exploration, Run Internships And Training Programmes”



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Epson recently announced a strategic tie-up with a university to provide robotics training. EFY's Akanksha Gaur spoke with Siva Kumar from Epson to understand the thinking behind the initiative. Here is what she discovered...

What technology and energy trends shape robotics, and how can industry-ready engineers be developed?

Engineering education is increasingly integrating mechatronics, AI, and data science alongside traditional computer science, creating students with robotics-relevant skills. However, real-world factory automation presents different challenges, and companies such as Epson help bridge this gap.

We establish robot labs in universities for hands-on exploration, run internships and training programmes, and provide practical exposure to industrial automation. Recently, we trained 30 students and plan to train another group of 30 for 70-80 hours next quarter.

With labs in Bengaluru and Chennai, and plans to expand to other hubs, we align academic learning with industry applications to help build a workforce prepared for robotics adoption.

Is your robotics education programme mainly for talent development or strategic manufacturing readiness?

We view robotics education as a strategic pillar rather than solely a corporate social responsibility initiative.

This year, we introduced 72-hour training modules for students. Training 30 students in a few cities is only the beginning. We intend to scale the programme further and update the curriculum as new developments emerge.

The initiative will also extend to

system integrator engineers so they can better understand advanced manufacturing applications. Knowledge development is critical to accelerating robotics adoption and improving manufacturing readiness in India.

Another important area is precision tooling. While standard components such as PLCs and grippers are readily available, specialised tools for specific setups remain limited. By sharing knowledge and helping develop these small but essential tools, faster customisation and deployment can be enabled, strengthening the overall industrial ecosystem.

Which collaboration models link robotics education to industry, and how are they implemented?

We follow a hybrid approach that combines several collaboration models.

We provide input to engineering colleges when designing academic courses focused on manufacturing solutions while enabling students to gain hands-on experience in our laboratories. We also engage in joint research projects that allow students to work on real industrial challenges.

At the same time, we learn from industry practices to ensure knowledge flows both ways and students gain exposure that is directly relevant to current manufacturing needs.

How are partner institutions and student cohorts chosen to boost

employability and manufacturing impact?

We focus on both engineering colleges and diploma programmes as primary talent sources.

Recently, we trained students from MSRIT, VIT Chennai, MIT Chennai, and Sharda Shashtra University in Bengaluru. These engagements are ongoing and we plan to repeat them annually, including establishing labs that support hands-on learning and project development.

We also work with research-led universities to establish collaborative laboratories where industry experts and students can jointly develop solutions for complex manufacturing challenges. This approach combines practical industry experience with academic research, accelerating skill development, improving employability, and supporting applied innovation in regional manufacturing clusters.

What gaps exist between classroom robotics and real factory automation, and how are they addressed?

There is a clear gap between academic robotics knowledge and real-world factory automation, which requires collaboration across mechanical, electrical, mechatronics, AI, and programming disciplines.

In our labs, students quickly realise that complete automation cannot be achieved by one person alone. They explore a wide range of industrial robots